



Mahesh Benkar

Remote Controlling Your World

Get real-time help from afar for your ailing PC, or access that file that's miles away in minutes! Here's how...

It's something that's happened to all of us at some time. It's a Friday and your eyes let you see nothing more than to-do lists for the weekend. There's the date whose grown tired of your thousand and one excuses, and the party that demands your presence...You waltz away home, memorising the sequence in which the list has to be executed, and then the symphony throws up a flat note from real life! You just forgot to finish that document that nearly finished you off mentally!

Sprinting back to office is not an option you would like to look at! Now, if only there was a way of doing the damned thing from home!

It's the same scenario when asking for help on a lengthy phone conversation with the so-called help desks. If you could only let them access your desktop for a while and let them fix it remotely, indeed life might actually be worth living, for a change!

Here's the solution—simple remote access tools that let you do just that—access your PC remotely.

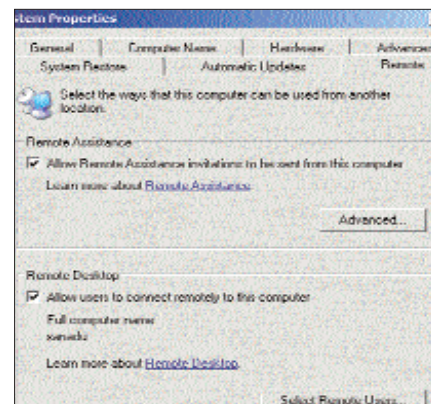
Help's on the way, remotely

Windows XP has a nifty little tool called Remote Assistance that does what its name states—troubleshoot computer problems from a distance.

Remote Assistance is easy to use and secure—no one can take control of your PC unless you send an invitation, and give the person proper authorisation. Along with Windows XP and an Internet connection, you need Windows Messenger 5.0 (which is available, by default, on XP), or greater installed on both the PCs.

STEP 1 Enabling Remote Access

To enable the Remote Assistance services, go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel**, and click on the System icon. Alternatively, you can use the **[Windows] + [Pause/Break]** keyboard shortcut. Under the Remote tab, check the 'Remote Assistance' box. Click on Advanced and ensure that the 'Allow this computer to be remotely controlled' checkbox is ticked. Let the default setting for the amount of time the invitation can remain open stay as 30 days. Keep clicking on OK till you exit the menu.



Enable Remote Assistance in the Remote tab of the System dialog box to send invitations from your PC

STEP 2 Inviting the expert

Initiate a Remote Assistance session either using Windows Messenger or e-mail.

Log on using your standard MSN .NET ID, which is the same as the one you use for MSN Messenger. Right-click on the expert's ID in the main window and select 'Ask for Remote Assistance' to send an invitation to the expert.